

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	ENGL1003
Subject Title	Introduction to English-Speaking Cultures
Credit Value	3
Level	1
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None
Objectives	The central objective of this subject is to develop students' awareness and understanding of key factors that shape contemporary life across English-speaking cultures. In an effort to enhance students' global communicative competence, students will analyse the different roles of English across media, public discourse, public policy, and local communities of practice in different countries and territories. The course focuses on the English-speaking inner circle countries, including the UK, the USA, Canada, Australia, and New Zealand. It also provides additional focus on English-speaking outer circle territories such as Hong Kong, Singapore, and India, as well as expanding circle countries like Korea and Japan. The examination of English-speaking cultures is essentially an exercise in critical cultural analysis, furthering students' understanding of the many factors that affect and are affected by language and society, while eliminating the concept of English as a monocultural entity.
Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 1)	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to demonstrate an informed understanding of the historical factors, political structures, and other cultural practices that have shaped and continue to shape English-speaking cultures around the world. Specifically, students will be able to: a. understand the necessity for global communicative competence and its role in mediating communication across and between English-speaking societies; b. evaluate critically the beliefs and values of these cultures with respect to nationality, ethnicity, customs and traditions; c. map the placement of their own societies and cultures within the English-speaking sphere; d. understand the diversity of aspects of personal and social identity, including gender relations, family life, and work, present across English-speaking territories; e. demonstrate a clear understanding of the roles of the arts and media in these cultures and their impact on the rest of the world; f. show improved intercultural awareness by better understanding the relationships between and roles of national and international policy across English-speaking cultures; and g. critically analyse the global impact of the English language and its cultures.

Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus (Note 2)	• Nationality and ethnicity: the role of national and social policies within English-speaking cultures and the establishment of both national and ethnic identities and social norms; • Education and employment: attitudes towards education, school and university life, vocational training, etc; • Personal identity: gender roles, family life, religious affiliation, work and leisure, etc; • Public policy and international politics: forms of government and public policy within nations and the role international policy has played in an increasingly connected world; • Mass communication: top-down and bottom-up communication; mainstream and subversive forms of media and communication; and the role of the internet and language in defining or redefining identity at all levels; and • Global communicative competence: synthesising all of the above and how they affect communication between individuals and groups at the global level.																																																				
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	The teaching and learning approach is task-based, student-centred, interactive, and reflective. There is a balance of individual effort and cooperative interdependent learning in order to personalise and socialise the learning process.																																																				
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="7">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th><th>e</th><th>f</th><th>g</th></tr><tr><td>1. Group presentation</td><td>30%</td><td></td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>2. Individual responses to discussion questions</td><td>30%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>3. Term paper</td><td>40%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100%</td><td colspan="7"></td></tr></table> The main purpose of the assessed tasks is to check students’ understanding of key concepts and their ability to apply these concepts to the analysis of aspects of particular English-speaking cultures. The aim is also to ensure that assessment is for learning as well as of learning. The assessment tasks reflect this philosophy in the way they meet ILOs: the group presentation provides the chance for students to understand particular English-speaking contexts, identify emerging issues within these contexts, and critically engage with these issues; the individual responses to discussion questions give students the opportunity to further reflect on discussion questions posed in group presentations and discussed in class relating to the themes/concepts covered; and the term paper permits individual reflection, analysis, and discussion of a self-chosen aspect/area of the English-speaking cultures.	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)							a	b	c	d	e	f	g	1. Group presentation	30%		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	2. Individual responses to discussion questions	30%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	3. Term paper	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	Total	100%							
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3. Term paper	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓																																													
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Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures	39 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Private study	56 Hrs.
	▪ Take-home assignments	28 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	123 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Reading list Bolton, K., & Moody, A. J. (2024). English in Hong Kong and Macau. In A. J. Moody (Ed.), <i>The Oxford handbook of Southeast Asian Englishes</i> (pp. 202–230). Oxford University Press. https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780192855282.013.9 Galloway, N., & Rose, H. (2015). <i>Introducing global Englishes</i> (1st ed.). Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315734347 Schneider, E. W. (2006). English in North America. In B. B. Kachru, Y. Kachru, & C. L. Nelson (Eds.), <i>The handbook of world Englishes</i> (pp. 58–73). Blackwell Publishing. https://doi.org/10.1002/9780470757598.ch4 Schneider, E. W. (2007). <i>Postcolonial English: Varieties around the world</i>. Cambridge University Press. Sridhar, S. N. (2020). Indian English. In K. Bolton, W. Botha, & A. Kirkpatrick (Eds.), <i>The handbook of Asian Englishes</i> (pp. 243–277). Wiley Blackwell. https://doi.org/10.1002/9781118791882.ch10 Reading list for group presentation Bourhis, R. Y., & Giles, H. (1977). The language of intergroup distinctiveness. In H. Giles (Ed.), <i>Language, ethnicity and intergroup relations</i> (pp. 119–135). Academic Press. Bucholtz, M. (1999). Why be normal?: Language and identity practices in a community of nerd girls. <i>Language in Society</i>, 28(2), 203–223. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0047404599002043 Bucholtz, M., & Lopez, Q. (2011). Performing blackness, forming whiteness: Linguistic minstrelsy in Hollywood film. <i>Journal of Sociolinguistics</i>, 15(5), 680–706. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1467-9841.2011.00513.x Clay, A. (2003). Keepin' it real: Black youth, hip-hop culture, and black identity. <i>American Behavioral Scientist</i>, 46(10), 1346–1358. https://doi.org/10.1177/0002764203046010005 Duff, P. A. (2002). The discursive co-construction of knowledge, identity, and difference: An ethnography of communication in the high school mainstream. <i>Applied Linguistics</i> 23(3), 289–322. https://doi.org/10.1093/applin/23.3.289 Eades, D. (2000). I don't think it's an answer to the question: Silencing Aboriginal witnesses in court. <i>Language in Society</i>, 29(2), 161–195. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0047404500002013 Gumperz, J. J. (1982/2005). Interethnic communication. In S. F. Kiesling & C. B. Paulston (Eds.), <i>Intercultural discourse and communication: The essential readings</i> (pp. 33–44). Blackwell. https://doi.org/10.1002/9780470758434.ch3 Labov, W. (1972/1997). The social stratification of (r) in New York city department stores. In N. Coupland & A. Jaworski (Eds.), <i>Sociolinguistics: A reader</i> (pp. 168–178). Macmillan Education.	

	McKay, S. L., & Wong, S.-L. C. (1996). Multiple discourses, multiple identities: Investment and agency in second-language learning among Chinese adolescent immigrant students. <i>Harvard Educational Review</i>, 66(3), 577–608. https://doi.org/10.17763/haer.66.3.n47r06u264944865 Milroy, J. (2001). Language ideologies and the consequences of standardization. <i>Journal of Sociolinguistics</i>, 5(4), 530–555. https://doi.org/10.1111/1467-9481.00163 Rickford, J. R., & King, S. (2016). Language and linguistics on trial: Hearing Rachel Jeantel (and other vernacular speakers) in the courtroom and beyond. <i>Language</i>, 92(4), 948–988. https://doi.org/10.1353/lan.2016.0078 Tagliamonte, S. A. (2016). So sick or so cool? The language of youth on the internet. <i>Language in Society</i>, 45(1), 1–32. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0047404515000780 Trudgill, P. (1974). The social differentiation of English in Norwich. In N. Coupland & A. Jaworski (Eds.), <i>Sociolinguistics: A reader</i> (pp. 179–184). Macmillan Education. Further resources Jenkins, J. (2014). <i>Global Englishes: A resource book for students</i>. Routledge Kachru, B. B. (Ed.). (1992). <i>The other tongue: English across cultures</i>. University of Illinois Press. Leap, W., & Boellstorff, T. (Eds.). (2004). <i>Speaking in queer tongues: Globalization and gay language</i>. University of Illinois Press. Ochs, E., & Schieffelin, B. B. (2012). The theory of language socialization. In A. Duranti, E. Ochs, & B. B. Schieffelin (Eds.), <i>The handbook of language socialization</i> (pp. 1–21). Wiley-Blackwell. https://doi.org/10.1002/9781444342901.ch1 Ronowicz, E., & Yallop, C. (Eds.). (2007). <i>English: One language, different cultures</i>. Continuum.
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Revised by Hyejeong Kim, July 2024